

on your desktop and select Properties. Add a space and a “-w” at the end of the target field so that it looks something like this:

“C:\Program Files\EA GAMES\The Sims 2\TSBin\Sims2.exe” -w

The path may, of course, vary depending on where you installed the game. Click OK and try and run the game.

Connection Negation

Q I have a 3 GHz Pentium 4 with 1 GB of RAM on Windows XP SP2. I want to connect to the Internet using my Soft V92 Data Fax Modem. When I try to do so, I find that the “Connect using a dialup connection” and the “Connect using a broadband connection” options are disabled.

Mohit Budhrani

A There are a number of reasons for this to happen. First, make sure that the Remote Access Connection Manager service is Started, and that its Startup Type is set to Manual. On XP, you can check this by going to Control Panel > Administrative Tools > Services. If this doesn’t seem to work, one the following methods will do the trick.

Method 1

Open the Registry Editor. Locate and click the following key:

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Telephony\Cards

Delete **NextID** in the right pane. Exit the Registry Editor and restart the computer. Start the New Connection Wizard, and then create a new dial-up modem or PPPoE connection. If the issue is not resolved, try this:

Method 2

Open the Registry Editor. Locate and click the following key:

HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Telephony

Delete the key. Exit the Registry Editor. Perform an in-place upgrade of Windows XP, that is, a repair installation of Windows XP as follows. Boot using your Windows XP CD. When the system prompts you to press [R] to run the recovery console to repair Windows, do not do so. Choose to install a new version of Windows instead. The setup program will then proceed and detect the old copy of Windows. Now it will tell you to press [R] to repair it or [Esc] to install a new version. Press [R]; setup will then proceed to re-install Windows over the old version while retaining all programs, settings and data files. If this does not solve your problem, proceed to Method 3.

Method 3

Open the Control Panel and under Phone and Modem Options, set the area code and other desired settings. If the My Location item has not been created, the New Connection Wizard to create it should automatically appear. You can use this Wizard to enter the area code and other settings. When you’re finished with the Wizard, restart the computer. The Connect using a dial-up modem option should now be available to you.

Virus Hell

Q I installed Norton Antivirus 2005 and it detected the virus Infostealer.Banker.D, but is not able to remove it.

Vidya Charan



A Follow these steps to remove the virus. First disable System Restore. To do this, open System from the Control Panel, click on the System Restore tab, and check the box next to “Disable System Restore on all drives”.

Update the virus definitions and the anti-virus itself, then run a full and thorough system scan.

Delete the values created by the virus in the Registry: in the Registry Editor, delete these keys:

```
HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Helper\“D
Name” = “[ENCRYPTED STRING1]”
HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Helper\“D
om” = “[HEX VALUES]”
HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Helper\“G
UID” = “[ENCRYPTED STRING2]”
HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Classes\C
LISD\“[TROJAN_BHO CLSID]”
HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\Software\Microsoft
\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Brow
ser Helper Objects\[TROJAN_BHO CLSID]
Exit the Registry Editor. If for some reason
you are not able to open the Registry Editor,
download and run the tool developed to remove
these keys from :
http://securityresponse.symantec.com/
avcenter/venc/data/tool.to.reset.shell
lopencommand.registry.keys.html or
http://tinyurl.com/yrotz.
```

Explorer Error

Q I use Windows XP Pro with SP2, and I recently installed Internet Explorer 7 Beta. It was working fine, but last week I found that IE wasn’t opening. An error message is showing up, stating this:

“iexplorer.exe—Entry Point Not Found : The procedure entry point InternetGetSecurityInfoByURLW could not be located in the dynamic link library WININET.dll”.

Chandan Munshi

A To fix the problem, do the following:
a Uncompress the IE7 installer file to a directory like C:\IE7Inst

- ☐ Restart your computer and use any live OS CD such as WinPE or Ubuntu Live to boot your computer.
- ☐ Copy wininet.dll and urlmon.dll from the IE7Inst directory to %windir%\System32\
- ☐ Reboot your computer. ☐